

SARS treatment of crypto assets (CGT overview)

SARS & CRYPTO ASSETS — EDUCATIONAL NOTE

Core idea

Crypto assets (including cryptocurrencies) are typically not treated as South African legal tender, but disposals can be taxable events. Depending on facts, gains may fall under capital gains tax rules (or revenue treatment if you trade as a business).

Practical checklist for individuals

- Keep records of acquisition date, cost, disposal date and proceeds for every trade or spend.
- “Disposal” can include selling for Rand, swapping one token for another, or using crypto to pay for goods.
- Declare correctly on your return; penalties apply for non-disclosure.

When to get advice

High-volume traders, offshore platforms, and estate planning with crypto need professional tax advice.

NOTE: Not SARS official text. Confirm on www.sars.gov.za before filing.

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